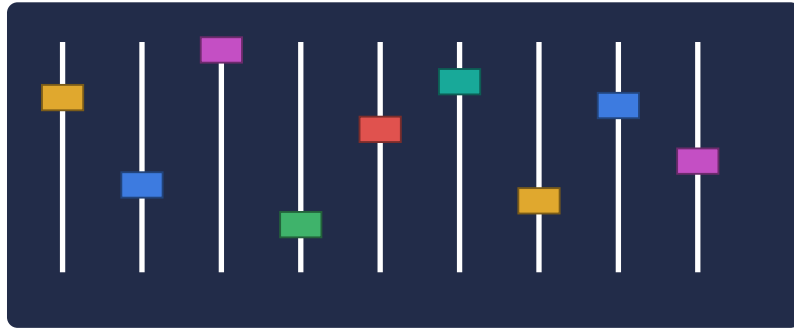


DMXpress

The Console Upgrade

How it used to work — and how it works now



From a one-look DMX tool → a grandMA3-style lighting console

A visual companion to `GUIDE.md` • June 14, 2026

What changed, in one breath

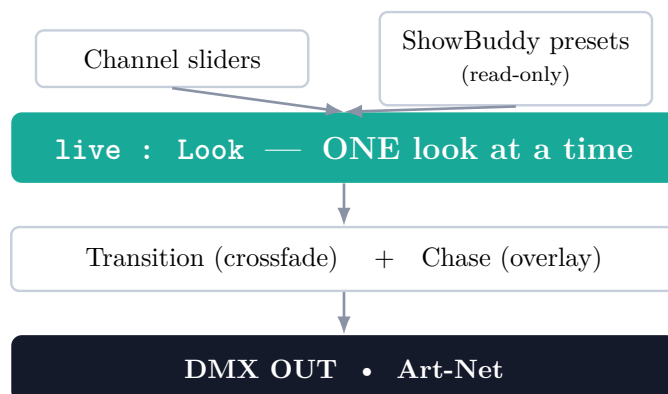
DMXpress began as a simple controller: you picked a fixture, dragged some sliders, and whatever you were touching went straight out the door. It is now a small *console* — with reusable selections, referenced presets, effects, recorded cue lists, and a fader bank — built around one professional idea: a **Programmer** that always sits on top of your **Playback**.

Area	Then	Now
Output model	One live look straight to DMX	Mixer of layers, Programmer on top
Selecting	Click a fixture	Click + reusable Groups
Storing looks	ShowBuddy presets (read-only)	Palettes per feature (your own)
Effects	Chases (one moving preset)	Phasers across a selection
Playback	Transition crossfade	Stacks (tracking cues) + Decks
Master	—	Grand Master + per-stack faders
Operating	Mouse only	Command line + Views

1 The big shift: one look becomes a console

1.1 THEN the old signal flow

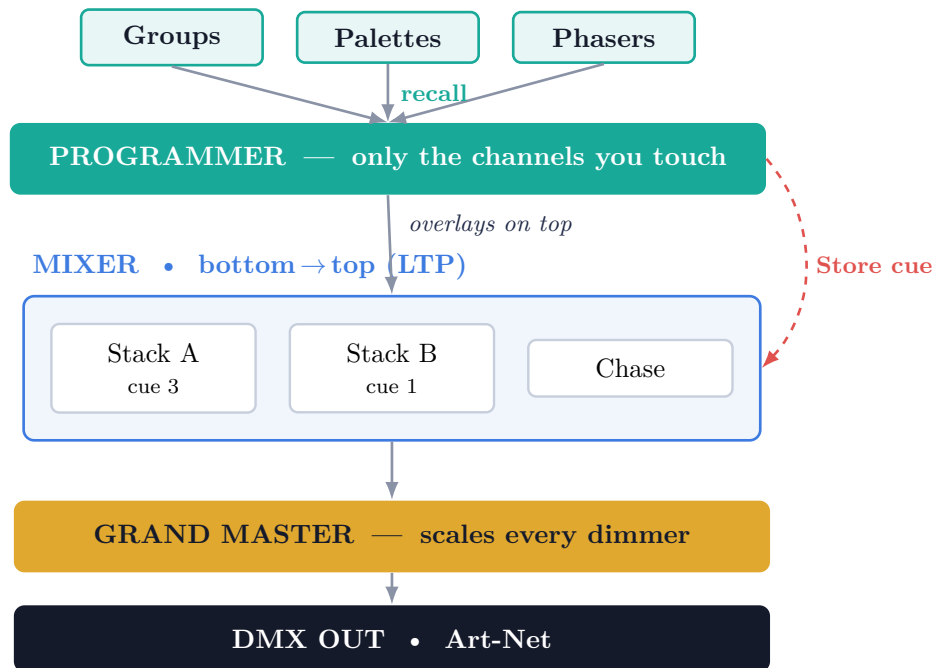
Everything funnelled into a single **Look**. Editing a channel *was* the show; there was nowhere to *store* your own looks and nothing playing underneath.



No stored Groups, Palettes, or Cues. No faders. Whatever you edit is the output.

1.2 NOW the console pipeline

The pools (Groups, Palettes, Phasers) feed a **Programmer**. The Programmer overlays *only the channels you touched* on top of a **Mixer** of playing Stacks. **Store** records the Programmer down into a cue; a **Grand Master** trims the whole rig on the way out.

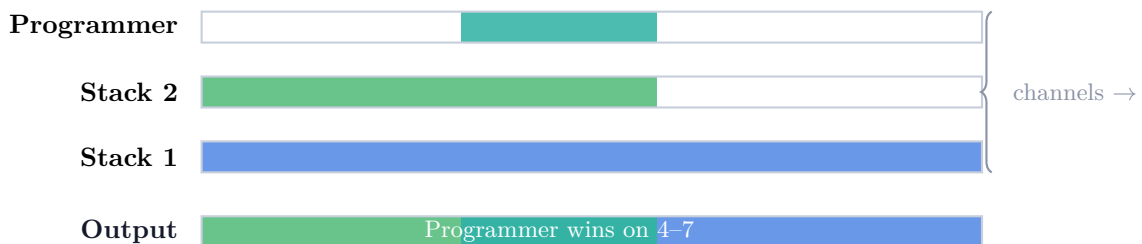


2 The mental model: Programmer on top of Playback

The idea

You **build** a look in the **Programmer** (your scratch pad), then **Store** it into something reusable. Playback (Stacks/Decks) runs *underneath* the Programmer, so whatever you are editing always wins — until you **Clear**.

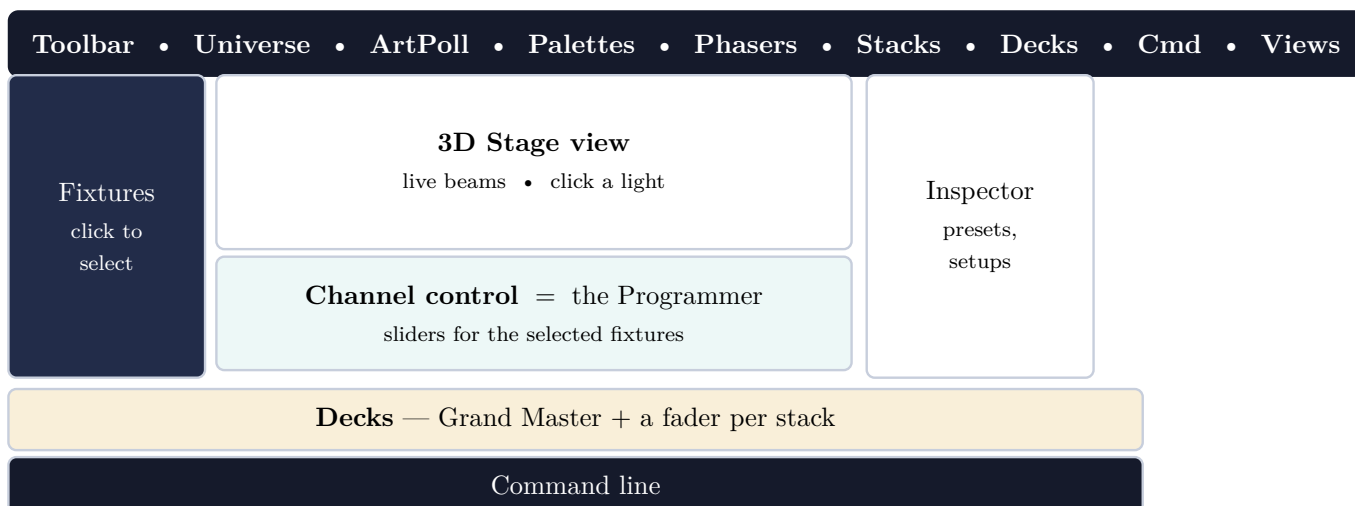
The Programmer only asserts the channels you have touched since the last Clear. Below, two Stacks are playing; you are editing channels 4–7, so the Programmer overrides exactly those and the rest of the show tracks through untouched.



The #1 newcomer trap

If your faders and **Go** button “do nothing”, the Programmer is still holding those channels. Press **Clear prog** (or type **clear**) to release it so your Stacks and Decks take over the output.

3 The screen now



Floating pools (Palettes, Phasers, Stacks, Groups, Views) open on top from the toolbar. Every panel has its own zoom control.

4 Then vs Now, feature by feature

4.1 Selecting & setting values

	THEN	NOW
Selection	Click one fixture at a time.	Click, Shift -click to add/remove, Cmd -click for same type — and save selections as Groups .
Values	Drag channel sliders; that is the output.	Same sliders, but every channel you touch joins the Programmer (an overlay you can store or clear).

4.2 Storing looks: Palettes (the big new idea)

Why Palettes change everything

A **Palette** stores a value for *one feature* — Color, Position, Dimmer, Beam, Focus, or Control. Recall “Blue” without moving the lights; recall “Center” without changing their color. Cues remember the *palette reference*, so re-tinting “Blue” updates every cue that used it.

The six feature pools, each its own tab in the Palettes window:



THEN ShowBuddy presets were whole-rig and read-only. **NOW** you build your own, per feature, and reference them in cues.

4.3 Effects: Chases became Phasers

	THEN	NOW
Movement	A Chase swept one preset around a circle.	A Phaser drives any feature across your selection — sine, chase, rainbow, sweep — with <i>Spread</i> and <i>Wings</i> .
Reuse	Configured live, not stored.	Stored as tiles; click to re-apply, and they record into cues.

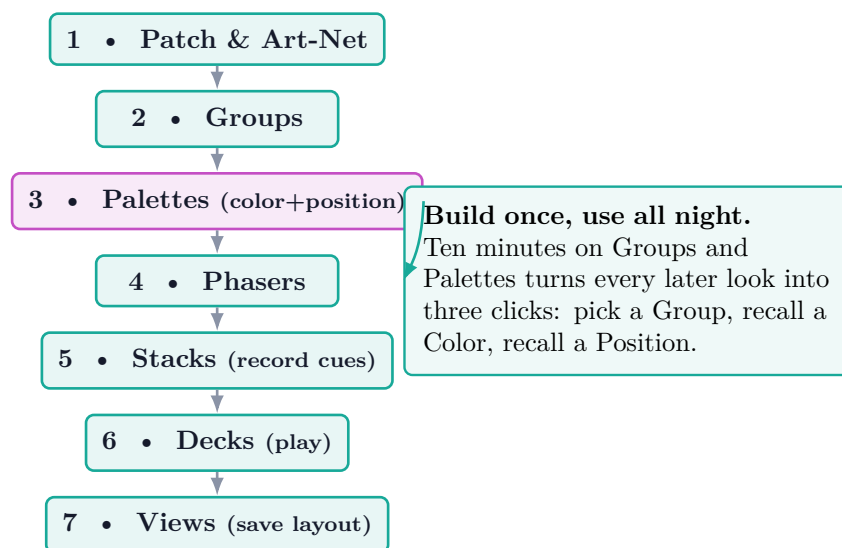
4.4 Playback: from a crossfade to cue stacks + faders

	THEN	NOW
Looks over time	One Transition crossfaded between looks.	A Stack is an ordered cue list; Go fades to the next cue. Untouched channels <i>track</i> through.
Surface	—	The Decks bar: a Grand Master plus a level fader, Go and Off per stack.

4.5 Operating: mouse, plus a command line and Views

THEN everything was clicks. **NOW** type clear, go, store, cue 3, group 1, gm 80 on the **Command** line, and snap window layouts with **Views**.

5 The new workflow



6 Worked example: a tiny show in 3 cues

- A. **Group** — select all movers, **Groups** → name **Movers** → Store.
- B. **Palettes** — dial full blue → Color tab → Blue; dial red → Red. Point at the crowd → Position tab → Audience; point centre → **Center**.
- C. **Cue 1** — **Stacks** → +New Main. Recall **Movers**, Blue, **Center**, Dimmer Full. Fade 3s → **Store cue**.

D. Cue 2 — recall **Red** + **Audience** → **Store cue**.

E. Cue 3 — **Phasers** → load **Pan Sweep** → **Apply** → back to **Stacks** → **Store cue**.

F. Play — **Clear prog** (!), open **Decks**, push the **Main** fader up, press **Go** to step the cues. Pull **GM** down to dim the rig.

Tip

Everything is saved to disk automatically. Reopen DMXpress and your groups, palettes, phasers, stacks and views are all still there.

7 Reference

7.1 Command line

command	does
<code>clear</code>	Release the Programmer
<code>black / bo</code>	Blackout — release every stack and clear the Programmer
<code>go [n]</code>	Go on the current stack (or stack <i>n</i>)
<code>off [n]</code>	Release all stacks (or stack <i>n</i>)
<code>store</code>	Store a cue into the current stack
<code>cue n</code>	Jump the current stack to cue <i>n</i>
<code>group n</code>	Recall (select) group <i>n</i>
<code>gm n / full</code>	Grand Master to <i>n</i> % / 100%

7.2 Where your show is saved

File	Contents
<code>groups.json</code>	Your Groups (saved selections)
<code>palettes.json</code>	Your Palettes (per-feature presets)
<code>phasers.json</code>	Your Phasers (effects)
<code>stacks.json</code>	Your Stacks and cues
<code>views.json</code>	Your saved Views (layouts)

The text guide lives in `GUIDE.md`. Build your Groups and Palettes first — the rest is a few clicks.